How Clear Is the Family's Picture of What Matters Most to Your Wife?

Twelve quick questions about what you've asked and what's written down. At the end: what you know, what's still open, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how much the family has talked about and written down. It doesn't measure your wife, and it doesn't measure you. If the first conversation hasn't happened yet, most of your answers will be “no” or “not sure,” and all that shows is where a conversation could start.

1. Have you asked your wife whether she's willing to talk about the future, and do you know her answer?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you know what she would call a good day, as she describes it herself?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know which routines and choices she most wants to keep?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Is what she said written down, in her own words where you have them?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Can you tell which of your notes are her words and which are your own conclusions?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Has each of the kids, and anyone else who would be involved, said what they hope for and what concerns them?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you know what each person could realistically offer, how often, and what they couldn't do?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Do you know where her wishes and the family's hopes already match?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Where two people expect different things, is it written down with both views left on the page?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you kept a list of the questions nobody in the family could answer?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Has she read, or heard read back, what was written about her wishes?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Have you agreed how you'll come back to this as life changes?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what the family has asked and written down, not how your wife is doing, and not how well anyone has done. A low count means there are conversations still to have, and they can be had one at a time.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what's been talked about, what's written down and what's still open. Keep the page you just copied beside you: the care interview goes through your wife's situation area by area, the open parts included, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›